



THE APERTURE METHOD™ · MASTER PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

# What we have **actually** built

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Reconstructed from the SOPs, the Agent Build Spec, the Lumina engagement, the SOW, the contract and the live codebase. Nothing here is proposed — this is the system as it exists on 10 Aug 2026.

# Bring your business into focus.

The Aperture Method moves an owner-run business from a first honest read to a living, visual intelligence platform. Each segment answers one executive question and produces one tangible deliverable the client keeps.

**Who it is for:** owner-run businesses, roughly \$1M–\$20M in revenue, place-based or data-rich. Senior-led throughout — the person who does the work is the person the client meets.

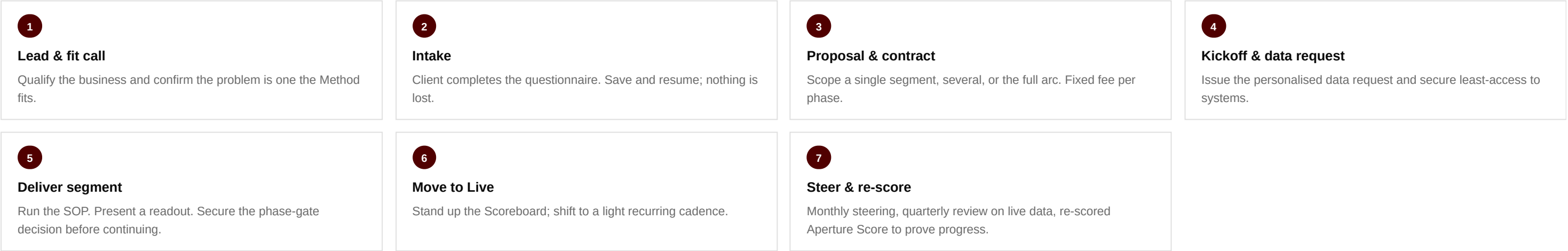
- Senior-led throughout.** No handoff to a junior team.
- Fixed-fee and phase-gated.** The client decides whether to continue at each gate — never an open-ended commitment.
- Plain language.** If we cannot explain why, we do not recommend on it.
- The client owns what we build.** Models, dashboards and playbooks built on their data are theirs to keep.
- A person reviews every output.** AI supports decisions; it does not make them.
- Measured on results.** We ask to be measured on whether the strategy shows up in the numbers.

## The offer

The Business X-Ray is the fixed-fee front door and the sales wedge. It produces the same core deliverable as Insights; when a client engages the full Method it is delivered inside the Insights phase.

| #  | SEGMENT                | VERB       | EXECUTIVE QUESTION                           | DELIVERABLE                         | DURATION |
|----|------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| —  | Business X-Ray™        | Diagnose   | Where do we stand, and what do we fix first? | Business X-Ray + Aperture Score™    | 2–3 wk   |
| 01 | Aperture Insights™     | Understand | What is happening?                           | Business X-Ray + Aperture Score     | 2–3 wk   |
| 02 | Aperture Analytics™    | Quantify   | Why is it happening?                         | Profit Map + scenario model         | 3–4 wk   |
| 03 | Aperture Intelligence™ | Reveal     | What opportunities does it reveal?           | Customer & Market Map + GIS package | 2–3 wk   |
| 04 | Aperture Compass™      | Navigate   | Where should we go next?                     | Opportunity Matrix + Focus Plan     | 1–2 wk   |
| 05 | Aperture Atlas™        | Perform    | How do we sustain results?                   | Scoreboard + KPI system             | Ongoing  |

## How an engagement runs



## What powers it

Human-led, AI-enabled. Five internal specialist agents compress the mechanical work — the reading, reconciling, modelling, mapping and monitoring — so judgment, context and accountability stay with a person the client can look in the eye. The agents produce findings, never conclusions. **Agent identities are internal; clients engage the Aperture modules, not the names.**

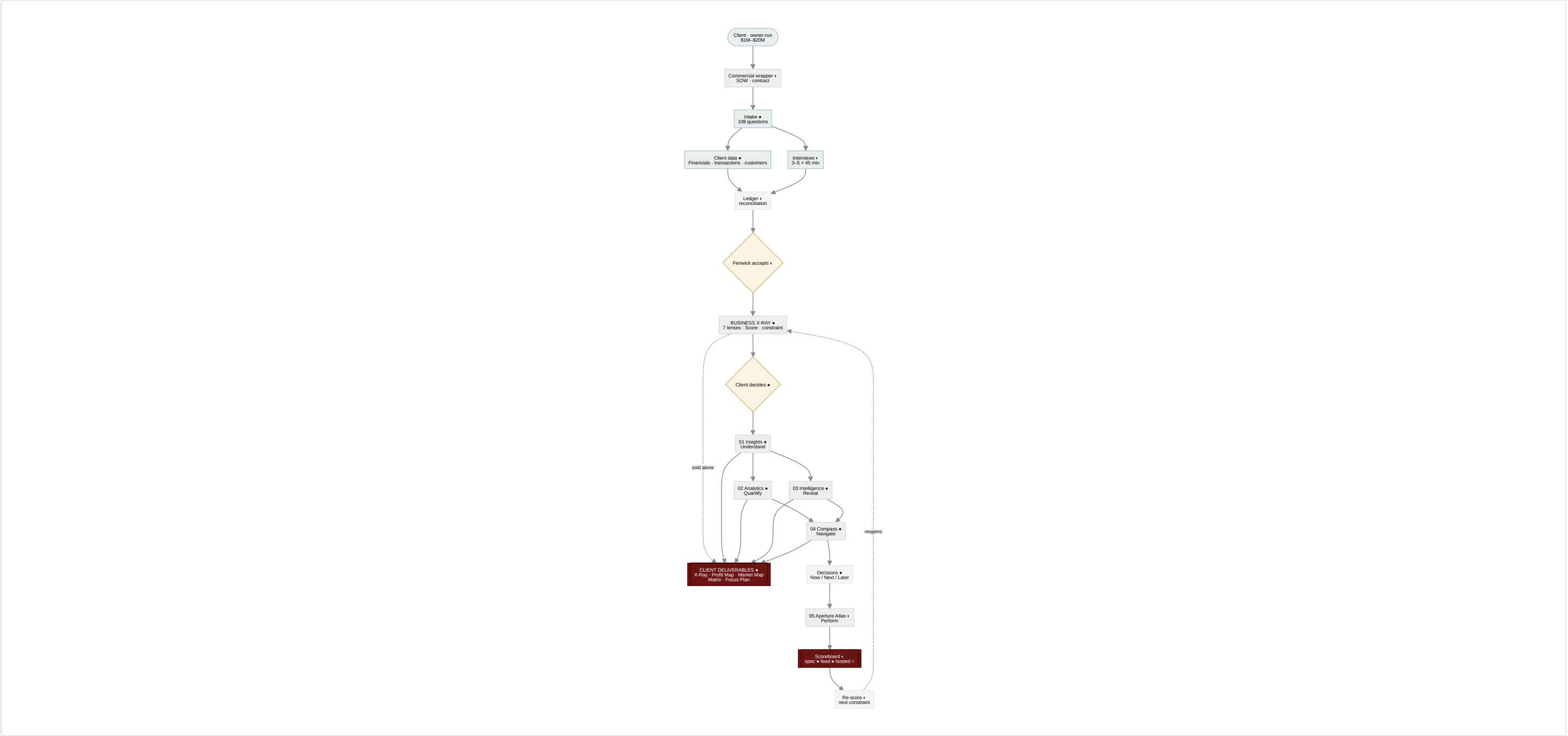
| INTERNAL           | CLIENT-FACING MODULE   | OWNS                                                         | STANDARD OF EVIDENCE                                     |
|--------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Lena · Strategist  | Aperture Insights™     | Seven-lens diagnostic, Aperture Score, constraint candidates | Refuses to render an uncited figure                      |
| Marcus · Analyst   | Aperture Analytics™    | Financial model, Profit Map, scenarios                       | Never does arithmetic in prose; reconciles to the dollar |
| Natalie · Explorer | Aperture Intelligence™ | Geocoding, segments, trade areas, site selection             | Never sees a street address; PII drops at the door       |
| Aria · Navigator   | Aperture Compass™      | Opportunity Matrix, sequencing                               | Every row cites its upstream finding                     |
| Thomas · Operator  | Aperture Atlas™        | KPIs, Scoreboard, re-score                                   | Escalates; never acts                                    |

**How to read the rest of this document.** Level 1 is the whole Method on one screen. Level 2 opens each phase into inputs, methods, agents, outputs and deliverables. Level 3 shows how information actually moves between them. The Gap Register lists what is missing, conflicting or orphaned. Status marks throughout: ● exists · ◐ partial · ○ missing · ◆ unclear.

| OBJECT TYPE                                                                                                                                                                             | BUILD STATUS                                                                                                                      | READING IT                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Input · client data</div> <div>Method · analysis</div> <div>AI agent · automation</div> <div>Output · internal</div> <div>Client deliverable</div> <div>Human gate · Fenwick</div> | <div>Exists — developed</div> <div>Partial — started</div> <div>Missing — required, absent</div> <div>Unclear — conflicting</div> | <div>Vertical spine = the client's journey.</div> <div>Left band = cross-cutting layers that serve every phase, not phases themselves.</div> <div>Dashed edge = loop or optional branch.</div> |

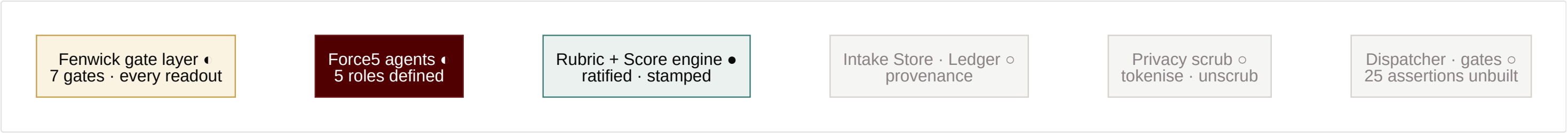
## The whole Method on one screen

Five phases sit inside a much larger machine. The commercial wrapper, the intake, the ledger and Fenwick's gate layer are cross-functional — they touch every phase and are where most of the unbuilt work sits.



## Cross-cutting layers

These serve every phase rather than sitting inside one. Four of the six exist only as specification — which is why the Method currently runs on Fenwick rather than on the machine.



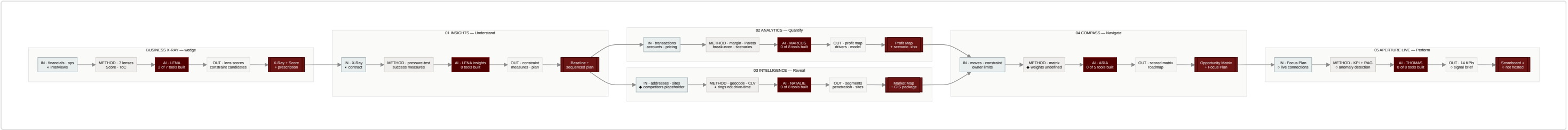
## Where the machine is thin

The client-facing surface is largely built. The layer underneath it — the thing that makes the Method repeatable rather than heroic — is mostly specification.

| LAYER                      | STATUS           | EVIDENCE                                                               |
|----------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Client-facing deliverables | ● <b>Exists</b>  | 8 real documents produced end-to-end for Lumina                        |
| SOPs 01–06                 | ● <b>Exists</b>  | Written, with inputs, steps, gates, handoffs                           |
| Intake + data request      | ● <b>Exists</b>  | 108 questions, save/resume, personalised data request, tracking views  |
| Aperture Score engine      | ● <b>Exists</b>  | Ratified v1.1.0, deterministic, version-stamped, 28 tests              |
| Force5 agents              | ◀ <b>Partial</b> | Roles, tool allowlists and refusals written; tool bodies unimplemented |
| Phase tooling              | ○ <b>Missing</b> | ~20 named tools; only <code>scoring.py</code> real                     |
| Ledger / provenance store  | ○ <b>Missing</b> | DuckDB store, token map, provenance envelope — spec only               |
| Dispatcher + gate engine   | ○ <b>Missing</b> | 2 of 7 gate checklists exist in YAML; 25 assertions unimplemented      |
| Hosted Scoreboard          | ○ <b>Missing</b> | Delivered as CSV feed + HTML mock-up; nothing wired or hosted          |
| Pricing / commercial terms | ◆ <b>Unclear</b> | SOW and Contract carry two irreconcilable schedules                    |

Component view — inputs → methods → agents → outputs → deliverables

One column per phase. Read left to right within each. The agent row is where the practice is most exposed: the roles are defined, the tools are named, and almost none of the tool bodies exist.



Human gates — where a person must act

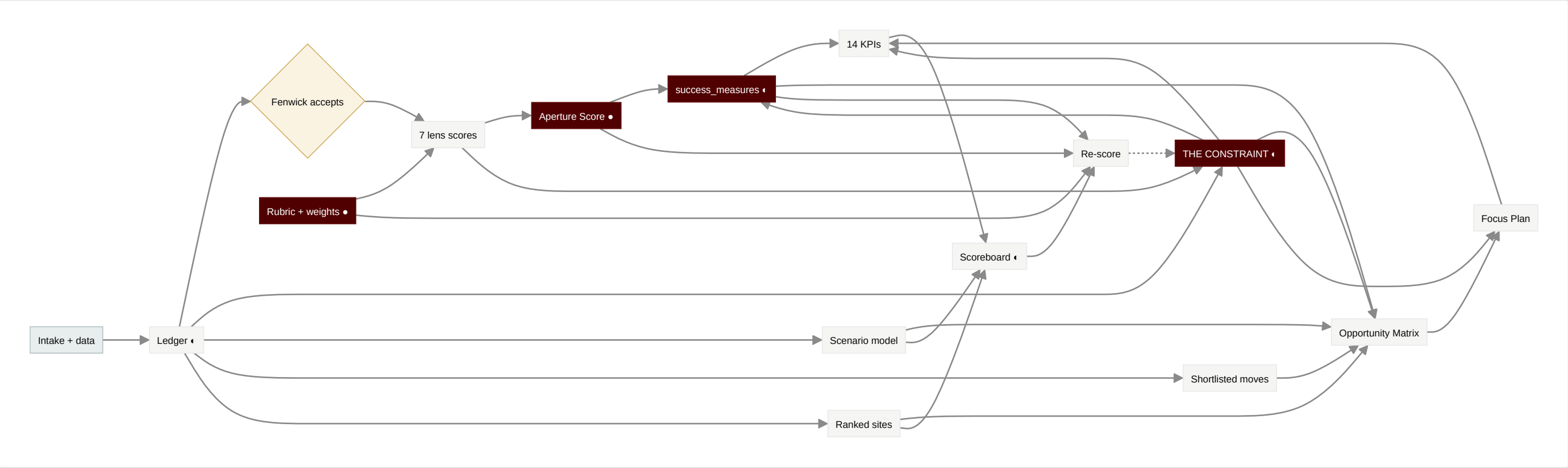
Six steps across the six SOPs are marked as Fenwick's. Three phases contain none at all, while the Build Spec claims he delivers every readout. That contradiction is the single largest structural inconsistency in the system.

| PHASE             | FENWICK STEPS                  | CLAIMED VS WRITTEN                                 |
|-------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Business X-Ray    | Kickoff · Interviews · Readout | Consistent                                         |
| 01 Insights       | Validate constraint · Readout  | Consistent                                         |
| 02 Analytics      | None                           | Spec says he approves allocation basis + scenarios |
| 03 Intelligence   | None                           | Spec says he owns every site recommendation        |
| 04 Compass        | None                           | Spec says he owns the sequence                     |
| 05 Aperture Atlas | Set cadence                    | Spec says he reads every brief first               |



# Dependency view — how information actually moves

Thick crimson edges are the load-bearing objects: things consumed by three or more downstream components. If one of these is wrong, everything after it is wrong and nothing will say so.



| LOAD-BEARING OBJECT      | CONSUMERS                                                                                          | STATUS                                   |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| The binding constraint   | Insights validation · Analytics tie-back · Compass scoring · Compass sequence · Live KPI selection | Named by Fenwick, no artifact records it |
| success_measures[ ]      | Live KPIs · re-score baseline · Compass inputs · Focus Plan · Scoreboard                           | Defined in SOP 02, no tool produces it   |
| Rubric + weights version | Every lens score · composite · every future re-score                                               | Ratified, stamped, enforced in code      |
| The ledger               | All five agents read it directly                                                                   | Store does not exist                     |
| Aperture Score baseline  | X-Ray · Live re-score · client trend line                                                          | Engine live                              |
| Scenario model           | Compass stress-test · Scoreboard forecast                                                          | Built by hand for Lumina                 |

THE DIFFERENTIATOR

A marketing agency optimises ad clicks. A CPA reconciles last year.

**We apply financial modelling, marketing science, management science, spatial econometrics and strategy** — the analytical depth a \$1M–\$20M owner-run business can otherwise only buy from a firm that will not take its call.

What it costs the client, and what they get for it

Left column: the inputs a phase cannot run without. **Blocking** means work stops; **helpful** means the answer gets better. Right column: the methods applied to those inputs. ● applied in a delivered engagement · ◌ in the method catalogue, not yet evidenced in client work.

| BUSINESS X-RAY™ + 01 INSIGHTS™                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  | UNDERSTAND · 2–3 WK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                   |  |  |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------|--|--|--|
| <div>WHAT THE CLIENT PROVIDES</div> <div><div><div>● Profit &amp; loss — 3 years plus YTD</div><div>● Balance sheet — 3 years</div><div>● Revenue split by product or service</div><div>○ Revenue split by location</div></div><div><div>● Payroll or headcount by role</div><div>● Capacity ceiling, monthly volume, seasonality</div><div>● Payment terms, receivables, debt obligations</div><div>● Three to five people for 45-minute conversations</div><div>○ Read-only access to the accounting system</div></div></div> |  | <div>QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS APPLIED</div> <div><div><div>Financial</div><div><div>● Ratio &amp; DuPont decomposition</div><div>● Unit economics — CAC, LTV, LTV:CAC, payback</div></div></div><div><div>Marketing science</div><div><div>▸ Marketing-mix modelling &amp; attribution</div></div></div></div> <div><div><div>Customer</div><div><div>● Cohort &amp; retention survival analysis</div><div>● Customer lifetime value modelling</div></div></div><div><div>Strategy</div><div><div>▸ Porter's Five Forces &amp; value chain</div></div></div></div> <div><div>Management science</div><div><div>● Theory of Constraints</div><div>▸ Capacity &amp; utilisation — Little's Law, queuing</div></div></div> <div><div>Scoring</div><div><div>● Seven-lens rubric → weighted Aperture Score™</div></div></div> |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |                   |  |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  | 02 APERTURE ANALYTICS™                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  | QUANTIFY · 3–4 WK |  |  |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  | <div>WHAT THE CLIENT PROVIDES</div> <div><div><div>● Transaction-level export — date, amount, customer ID</div><div>● Chart of accounts; delivery cost separated from overhead</div><div>● Owner compensation, one-offs, related-party costs</div></div><div><div>● Price list with discounts, packages, memberships</div><div>● Volume by product, location and month</div><div>● Accounting basis — cash or accrual, one ledger or several</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  | <div>QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS APPLIED</div> <div><div><div>Financial</div><div><div>● Contribution-margin &amp; CVP analysis</div><div>● Break-even analysis</div><div>● Scenario &amp; sensitivity analysis</div><div>▸ Capital budgeting — NPV, IRR, payback</div></div></div><div><div>Statistics</div><div><div>▸ Regression — linear, multiple, logistic</div><div>▸ Time-series forecasting — smoothing, ARIMA, seasonal decomposition</div></div></div></div> <div><div><div>Customer</div><div><div>▸ RFM &amp; cluster segmentation — k-means</div><div>▸ Market-basket / affinity analysis</div></div></div><div><div>Management science</div><div><div>▸ Optimisation / linear programming</div></div></div></div> <div><div>Marketing science</div><div><div>▸ Price-elasticity analysis</div></div></div> |  |                   |  |  |  |



| 03 APERTURE INTELLIGENCE™ |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                   |                                                                                                    | REVEAL · 2–3 WK |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| WHAT THE CLIENT PROVIDES  | QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS APPLIED                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                   |                                                                                                    |                 |
|                           | Spatial                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Customer                                                                          | Statistics                                                                                         |                 |
|                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Site-selection suitability — weighted overlay / MCDA</li></ul>                                                                                                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Segmentation and CLV by geography</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Churn / propensity modelling — logistic regression</li></ul> |                 |
|                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Trade-area and drive-time modelling</li><li>Gravity / Huff trade-area models</li><li>Hot-spot Getis-Ord Gi* &amp; spatial autocorrelation Moran's I</li><li>Geodemographic segmentation</li></ul> |                                                                                   |                                                                                                    |                 |

| 04 APERTURE COMPASS™     |                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                    |                                                                                    | NAVIGATE · 1–2 WK |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| WHAT THE CLIENT PROVIDES | QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS APPLIED                                                                                                                   |                                                                                    |                                                                                    |                   |
|                          | Decision science                                                                                                                                | Strategy                                                                           | Financial                                                                          |                   |
|                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Multi-criteria decision analysis — weighted matrix</li></ul>                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Ansoff &amp; growth-share matrices</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>NPV / IRR on the shortlisted moves</li></ul> |                   |
|                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Decision trees &amp; expected value</li><li>Scenario stress-testing against the Analytics model</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Real-options sequencing</li></ul>            |                                                                                    |                   |

| 05 APERTURE LIVE™                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                       | PERFORM · ONGOING |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| WHAT THE CLIENT PROVIDES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS APPLIED                                                       |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                       |                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Performance                                                                         | Statistics                                                                                                                          | Experimental                                                                          |                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Balanced Scorecard KPI architecture</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Statistical process control</li><li>Time-series forecasting &amp; anomaly detection</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>A/B testing &amp; experimental design</li></ul> |                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Marketing science                                                                   | Scoring                                                                                                                             |                                                                                       |                   |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Live connections — accounting, POS, CRM, marketing</li><li>Who authorises system access</li><li>For each number: what means on track, what means call me</li><li>A named human owner per number</li><li>The meeting this should feed, and when it runs</li><li>Anything that cannot connect and needs manual upload</li></ul> |                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Attribution &amp; channel value</li></ul>                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Re-score on stored rubric version</li></ul>     |                   |

## Honest read on the catalogue

Of roughly 33 methods named across the five phases, 11 are evidenced in the Lumina engagement. The remaining 22 are real capability claims that no delivered artifact yet demonstrates. That gap is not a problem with the positioning — the positioning is the right one — it is the build list that makes the positioning true. Each one becomes defensible the first time it appears in a client deliverable with its working shown.

# Gap register

Grouped by kind. Ordered within each by how much damage it does if left alone.

## Conflicts — two sources of truth

None. Every conflict found in the first audit has been settled; they are recorded below with the decision that closed each one. What remains in this register is missing work, not disagreement.

## Resolved — closed since the first audit

| ITEM                     | RESOLUTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The seven lenses         | <b>Ratified. Finance 20 · Operations 18 · Customers &amp; Retention 18 · Market &amp; Competition 14 · Leadership &amp; Team 12 · Processes 10 · Technology &amp; Data 8. One source (rubric.json v1.1.0) with one site-side mirror (src/lib/lenses.ts). "Marketing &amp; growth engine" is retired — marketing evidence scores inside Customers &amp; Retention. The Lumina X-Ray, the kickoff pack, the intake form and the public pages were rebuilt to match.</b> |
| Score weights            | <b>The ratified rubric governs; the Build Spec figures (Customers 20 / Ops 15) are superseded. scripts/check-lenses.mjs runs on prebuild and fails the deploy if the site's names, order or weights drift from the rubric, if the intake form's lens headings disagree, if a retired lens name reappears anywhere in src, or if the rubric is ever un-ratified.</b>                                                                                                   |
| Atlas vs Live            | <b>Settled 10 Aug 2026: Aperture Atlas™ is the single name for component 05, used internally and with clients. "Aperture Live" is retired. The website carried the old name in eight files and now does not; the contract, Exhibit A and the intake form needed no change. A build-time guard blocks the retired name from returning.</b>                                                                                                                             |
| Phase count              | <b>Settled: five phases and six SOPs. The Business X-Ray is the fixed-fee entry diagnostic, not a phase — it is what SOP 01 covers, and it is delivered inside Phase 01 when a client engages the full Method. This keeps the five-verb tagline and the 1–5 deliverable numbering honest. Reference §2.1.2. Any artifact saying "six phases" is non-conformant.</b>                                                                                                   |
| Pricing                  | <b>Settled 10 Aug 2026: the SOW schedule governs. Business X-Ray \$9,500 fixed, credited toward the Full Method if the client proceeds within 60 days · Full Method \$41,000 (\$34,500 after that credit) · Aperture Atlas \$2,950/month, 6-month minimum. Exhibit A of the contract was rewritten to match and its "from" floors removed. Individual phase fees are quoted per engagement — the SOW never listed them, so none were invented.</b>                    |
| Reconciliation tolerance | <b>Not a conflict — two different thresholds that were being read as one. Reference §7.4: ledger acceptance tolerates aggregate variance of ≤0.5% provided every variance is itemised (a completeness threshold); figure publication tolerates nothing — anything entering a deliverable must reconcile exactly to source. Accepting a ledger does not license an unreconciled figure.</b>                                                                            |
| Who runs the readout     | <b>Settled: Reference §4.3.3 — every readout is delivered by a person. Agents do not send, present or correspond. The three SOPs that mark readout as AGENT are non-conformant and are tracked for amendment as decision D3, not left as an open question of principle.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## Missing — logically required, absent

| ITEM                             | CONSEQUENCE                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ~20 phase tools                  | <b>Every number is produced by hand. The Method is not yet repeatable without Fenwick doing the work</b>                                      |
| Ledger / provenance store        | <b>Nothing enforces "every figure traces to source" outside the scoring engine</b>                                                            |
| Hosted Scoreboard                | <b>Sold as live and wired; delivered as a monthly CSV drop and an HTML mock-up</b>                                                            |
| Signal Brief · anomaly detection | <b>Priced and described in the Build Spec; absent from SOP 06 entirely</b>                                                                    |
| Exhibit B                        | <b>Blank in the contract template — no record of the systems and data access granted. (Exhibit A now carries the published fee schedule.)</b> |
| NDA                              | <b>Referenced three times across intake and SOW; no artifact exists</b>                                                                       |
| Readout artifacts                | <b>Every SOP ends in a readout; no deck, agenda or notes template exists for any phase</b>                                                    |
| Interview guide + record         | <b>SOP 01 requires 3–5 interviews; Lumina shows none</b>                                                                                      |
| X-Ray in the web intake          | <b>The wedge — "the most common single purchase" — has no segment in the intake form</b>                                                      |

|                 |                                                          |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Gate assertions | 25 of 31 SOP checklist items have no machine counterpart |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|

Orphaned — defined, never used

| ITEM                   | NOTE                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ~20 named frameworks   | Porter, PESTLE, VRIO, BCG, MECE, SCQA, ICE/RICE, TAM/SAM/SOM, OKR, Balanced Scorecard — credentialed but outside every tool allowlist, so non-callable by rule |
| ~45 advertised methods | Playbook advertises ARIMA, k-means RFM, churn models, Huff gravity, Moran's I, LP optimisation. Lumina evidences roughly seven                                 |
| SyncPoint AI           | Named in the contract and SOP 06; used nowhere in the delivered engagement                                                                                     |
| Seven intake questions | Feed no rubric criterion and no SOP step                                                                                                                       |
| Stale agent filenames  | arthur · lin · marco · clara · darius — do not match the Force5 roster                                                                                         |